CORRELATION BETWEEN STUDENT AWARENESS AND PERCEIVED EFFECTIVENESS OF THE NDEP IN SELECTED PRIVATE HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS IN BAGUIO CITY

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Finally, this study is dedicated to the Filipino people, especially those whose lives have been affected by the continuing challenges of drug-related issues. Beyond every statistic lies a human story, and it is the researchers' sincere hope that this work contributes, however modestly, to greater awareness, meaningful dialogue, and the pursuit of a more compassionate and resilient nation.

- L.M.T.B. | R.N.B. | A.R.A.D. | J.G.L. |
N.A.S. | M.E.P.T. | A.F.P.T.

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Chapter 1

The Problem

Background of the Study

In an increasingly interconnected world, the proliferation of dangerous substances has evolved into a pressing global concern with far-reaching consequences. Beyond its impact on individual health, drug-related issues disrupt families, strain communities, impede socio-economic progress, and pose significant challenges to sustainable human development. According to the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC, 2024), addressing the global drug problem is a shared responsibility that requires a comprehensive and balanced approach integrating both supply and demand reduction strategies.

At the global level, mitigating youth substance abuse remains a critical priority for public health and sustainable development. Under Resolution 60/7, the Commission on Narcotic Drugs mandates that Member States align drug prevention efforts with international human rights obligations, including the Convention on the Rights of the Child. International frameworks, such as the Political Declaration and Plan of Action and the United Nations General Assembly special session outcome document, further emphasize the commitment of nations to implement

evidence-based demand reduction initiatives across schools, families, and communities.

Furthermore, Target 3.5 of the United Nations 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development specifically calls for the strengthening of substance abuse prevention and treatment efforts. To guide these initiatives, the International Standards on Drug Use Prevention identify primary prevention strategies that protect young individuals by providing accurate risk information, developing healthy social environments, supporting families, and ensuring equal access to education (UNODC, 2020). These global frameworks highlight the importance of preventive approaches that address not only substance use itself but also the social and environmental factors that influence young people's vulnerability to drug-related risks.

Educational institutions worldwide have become essential platforms for drug demand reduction by implementing preventive education programs designed to develop students' life skills, decision-making abilities, and self-efficacy to resist substance abuse. However, translating global prevention mandates into effective outcomes requires adaptive institutional systems because educational environments continue to experience challenges

brought by changing policies, resource limitations, and shifting social conditions.

Substance use disorders (SUDs) among adolescents and young adults aged 10–24 years remain a major global public health concern, contributing significantly to disease burden and mortality (Chen et al., 2025). In 2019, alcohol use accounted for 59,855 deaths, while drug use contributed to 16,391 deaths among individuals within this age group worldwide. During the same period, alcohol and drug use were associated with 5.9 million and 4.1 million disability-adjusted life years (DALYs), respectively. Although the global burden of alcohol use declined between 1990 and 2019, the burden of drug use increased among young males, with males consistently experiencing a higher burden compared to females. Regionally, Eastern Europe recorded the highest alcohol-related burden, while High-income North America experienced the highest drug-related burden (Li et al., 2019).

The consequences of adolescent substance use extend beyond mortality and include significant health, educational, and social impacts. Alcohol use during adolescence increases the risk of depression by three times (JAMA Pediatrics, 2021), while substance use increases the likelihood of youth dropping out of high school by five

times (National Institute on Drug Abuse, 2022). Similarly, cannabis use increases the risk of psychosis by 4.5 times (Lancet Psychiatry, 2023). Supporting these findings, the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (2024) reported that 15% of high school students had used illicit or injection drugs, while 14% had misused prescription opioids. The report further associated adolescent drug use with HIV infection, overdose, sexual risk behaviors, violence victimization, poor mental health, and suicide, emphasizing the importance of comprehensive school-based prevention initiatives.

Despite the recognized importance of educational institutions in preventing substance abuse, research indicates that the effectiveness of school-based interventions remains inconsistent. A systematic literature review using the PRISMA framework across Scopus and ERIC databases from 2020 to 2024 identified that leadership support, knowledge sharing, and a strong learning culture serve as primary mechanisms influencing institutional adaptability. The study emphasized that policymakers must move beyond regulatory frameworks and prioritize capacity-building and professional development to enable educational institutions to remain resilient and responsive to societal changes (Handrianto et al., 2026).

Similarly, global empirical evidence indicates that traditional school-based substance use interventions have demonstrated limited effectiveness. A recent overview of systematic reviews and meta-analysis found that these interventions showed moderate success in reducing tobacco use but minimal to no significant impact on alcohol, cannabis, and other illicit drug use. These findings highlight the need to transition toward more comprehensive and whole-school prevention strategies (Jenkins et al., 2026).

This limitation was further supported by an extensive systematic review and meta-analysis of 43 systematic reviews and 60 randomized controlled trials conducted from 2013 to 2024 involving youth aged 5 to 18 years. The findings demonstrated moderate-quality evidence that teaching and multicomponent interventions produced minor short-term reductions in tobacco use. However, low-quality evidence showed minimal effects on alcohol use and no significant effects on cannabis or illicit drug use. Since 62.8% of the reviewed studies were identified as critically low quality, the findings emphasized the need to move beyond isolated school programs toward broader, integrated prevention approaches (Jenkins et al., 2026).

To address these limitations, several evidence-based prevention frameworks have been implemented internationally with varying levels of success. The Unplugged curriculum, which focuses on psychosocial skill development and health education through 12 weekly units, demonstrated effectiveness in reducing the 30-day prevalence of cigarette use, cannabis use, and drunkenness among youth aged 12 to 14 years. Cluster randomized controlled trials conducted across Europe and the Czech Republic further confirmed delayed substance progression after an 18-month follow-up, particularly among boys (European Union Drugs Agency, 2024).

Similarly, a 13-year longitudinal study examining the Life Skills Training (LST) program found that students who participated in the intervention during middle school demonstrated significantly lower lifetime illicit drug use, marijuana use, and non-medical pill use during young adulthood compared to those in the control group (Griffin et al., 2023).

Another population-based approach, the Icelandic Prevention Model (IPM), provides an alternative framework by shifting attention away from individual-level instruction toward community-level prevention. The model continuously identifies and reduces localized risk factors

to delay the initiation of substance use among young people (Planet Youth, 2020).

Supporting these approaches, evidence further demonstrates that integrating targeted skills-based training within educational settings improves students' decision-making abilities, psychological well-being, and resistance to initiating recreational drug use (Alarcó-Rosales et al., 2021). These findings reinforce the importance of prevention programs that move beyond information dissemination and focus on strengthening students' abilities to make informed decisions.

Nevertheless, despite the presence of comprehensive drug prevention policies and international frameworks, significant challenges remain in translating these strategies into measurable outcomes within educational institutions. A global scoping review reported that institutions often fail to achieve consistent prevention outcomes due to weak coordination of resources, structural barriers, and persistent stigma toward individuals affected by substance use concerns (Liu et al., 2023). This highlights the importance of continuous evaluation and localized assessment to determine whether drug prevention programs are effectively implemented and responsive to the needs of their intended beneficiaries.

In response to the global call for comprehensive drug prevention strategies, the Philippines established national policies and institutional frameworks aimed at addressing substance abuse through education, prevention, and community-based interventions. The country's approach recognizes that reducing drug-related risks requires not only law enforcement measures but also preventive education, early intervention, and coordinated efforts among government institutions, communities, and educational organizations.

In the Philippines, this global mandate is operationalized through Section 43, Article IV of Republic Act No. 9165, otherwise known as the Comprehensive Dangerous Drugs Act of 2002. The law mandates that instruction on drug abuse prevention and control must be integrated into the curricula of all elementary, secondary, and tertiary educational institutions, both public and private. This legal provision establishes the responsibility of schools in developing students' awareness, knowledge, and skills necessary to prevent drug-related behaviors.

Beyond educational institutions, local drug prevention and rehabilitation strategies are also supported through community-based governance structures. Every local

government unit is mandated to establish an Anti-Drug Abuse Council (ADAC), including the Barangay Anti-Drug Abuse Council (BADAC) at the grassroots level. These councils serve as operational mechanisms for implementing localized drug prevention programs, conducting information and education campaigns (IECs), managing local drug-related concerns, and coordinating community-based rehabilitation programs for individuals affected by substance use.

Complementing these community-level strategies, institutional approaches have increasingly focused on educational settings as important environments for preventive intervention. To fulfill the educational requirements established under Republic Act No. 9165, the government implemented the National Drug Education Program (NDEP), reinforced through institutional policies such as DepEd Order No. 12, s. 2009. The program provides a holistic approach to drug prevention by emphasizing the harmful effects of dangerous drugs, preventive measures, socio-cultural and legal implications, and intervention mechanisms while avoiding approaches that may unintentionally contribute to stigma.

Although the National Drug Education Program was historically centered within basic education, its preventive principles continue to influence drug education

frameworks in tertiary institutions under the guidance of the Commission on Higher Education (CHED). This transition highlights the continuing responsibility of higher education institutions to promote student awareness, strengthen protective factors, and maintain supportive environments that prevent drug-related risks among young adults.

Despite the existence of national policies and prevention frameworks, substance use among Filipino adolescents remains a continuing concern. Pengpid et al. (2025) reported that one in seven Filipino adolescents engaged in current illicit drug use in 2019. The study further emphasized that strong parental support, peer support, and drug education were associated with lower levels of illicit drug use, highlighting the importance of strengthening school- and community-based prevention programs.

National reports further indicate that substance use commonly begins during adolescence. According to the Dangerous Drugs Board, as cited by Makati Medical Center (2024), nearly half of drug abuse cases in the Philippines begin between the ages of 15 and 19 years. Similarly, Parino (2022) reported that 23% of Filipino young adult males and 2% of young adult females were smokers, while

alcohol consumption was reported among 43% of young adult males and 17% of young adult females. Although smoking rates have declined, approximately 16% of Filipino youth continue to use vaping products, presenting additional health concerns among young populations.

These concerns emphasize the need to strengthen the implementation of school-based and institution-based prevention programs. Local baseline assessments indicate that while school-based prevention initiatives are structurally established, challenges remain in strengthening co-curricular activities, improving teacher training, and enhancing multi-sectoral partnerships to support a fully drug-free educational environment (Reyes, 2020). These findings suggest that the existence of policies alone does not guarantee effectiveness, as implementation quality and institutional capacity remain essential factors in achieving meaningful outcomes.

This continuing need for stronger institutional implementation is reflected in recent national prevention initiatives. In 2026, the Philippine Drug Enforcement Agency (PDEA), in partnership with the Department of Education (DepEd) and the Commission on Higher Education (CHED), introduced the pilot initiative entitled “The Northern Shield 2026: Empowering Educators for a Drug-Free

Ilocandia" (Bautista, 2026). The program was launched across the Ilocos Region and the Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR) in response to the Dangerous Drugs Board's (DDB) call for stronger school-based anti-drug advocacy.

The Northern Shield 2026 framework expands campus-based prevention beyond traditional punitive approaches by emphasizing awareness, resilience, early identification, and restorative support. The initiative specifically targets educators, NDEP coordinators, student affairs officers, and guidance counselors by equipping them with the capacity to identify early indicators of drug-related risks among students. Instead of focusing solely on disciplinary responses, trained personnel are encouraged to establish student support systems and connect individuals at risk with counseling, health services, and appropriate referral mechanisms (Bautista, 2026).

To operationalize this multi-sectoral approach, implementation requires coordination among DepEd, CHED, the Department of the Interior and Local Government (DILG), the Department of Health (DOH), and accredited civil society organizations. The initiative includes capability-building programs for school personnel, digital reporting and referral mechanisms, and the development of a Seal of Excellence to recognize institutions that maintain

supportive and drug-free environments. Through these strategies, the program aims to strengthen peer support networks, improve NDEP coordination, and establish a collaborative model involving schools, government agencies, communities, and families (Bautista, 2026).

The development of initiatives such as the Northern Shield 2026 demonstrates the continuous effort of the Philippine government to improve drug prevention strategies by integrating education, health, and institutional support. However, while national policies provide a strong foundation for prevention, differences in institutional capacity, resource availability, and implementation practices may influence how effectively these programs are experienced by students, particularly within private higher education institutions.

Despite the implementation of national policies and prevention frameworks, regional conditions demonstrate the continuing need for localized drug prevention strategies that consider the unique social, cultural, and institutional characteristics of specific communities. Within the Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR), law enforcement data highlights persistent challenges related to illegal drug production, distribution, and trafficking. These conditions emphasize the importance of strengthening

preventive approaches that address not only the supply of illegal substances but also the vulnerability of young individuals who may be exposed to drug-related risks.

Particularly concerning cannabis cultivation and methamphetamine hydrochloride (shabu) distribution, reports from the Police Regional Office Cordillera (PRO CAR) indicate that intensified anti-illegal drug operations in August 2025 resulted in significant drug seizures and the arrest of 38 drug personalities across 74 separate operations. These operations included 42 marijuana eradication campaigns, 19 buy-bust operations, six search warrant implementations, five arrest warrant services, and two immediate police responses. The total volume of confiscated substances included 126.6 grams of shabu, 93,528 fully grown marijuana plants, 12,290 marijuana seedlings, 25,000 grams of dried marijuana leaves and fruiting tops, and 38,000 grams of dried marijuana stalks. Among those arrested were 22 high-value individuals (HVIs) and 16 street-level individuals (SLIs).

Geographically, the Kalinga Police Provincial Office (PPO) recorded the highest volume of confiscations, followed by the Benguet PPO and the Baguio City Police Office (BCPO), while smaller shabu seizures were also documented in Mountain Province, Abra, and Ifugao

(Philippine Information Agency [PIA] CAR, 2025). These regional patterns demonstrate that drug-related concerns remain present across various areas of the Cordillera region, reinforcing the need for preventive interventions that complement law enforcement strategies.

The persistence of these concerns was further demonstrated through subsequent joint enforcement operations in the region. Combined police units and anti-narcotics agencies intercepted millions of pesos worth of illegal narcotics and arrested eight individuals, consisting of four high-value targets and four street-level targets. The operation resulted in the confiscation of 52.86 grams of shabu and 4,000.76 grams of dried marijuana leaves, leading to formal charges for violations of Republic Act No. 9165. At the same time, six marijuana eradication operations conducted in the mountainous areas of Benguet and Kalinga resulted in the discovery and destruction of 17,350 fully grown marijuana plants and 128,025 grams of dried marijuana stalks and fruiting tops (Herald Express, 2025; PIA CAR, 2025).

These regional conditions highlight the importance of prevention initiatives within educational institutions. Programs such as “The Northern Shield 2026” are particularly relevant in the Cordillera context because

they seek to reduce student vulnerability by strengthening awareness, early identification, and support mechanisms before drug-related risks develop into more serious concerns.

However, despite the implementation of drug prevention policies, regional evidence indicates that challenges remain in understanding how these programs operate within educational institutions. Existing studies conducted in various Philippine regions, including Region XII, reveal notable limitations in drug prevention research. Most investigations have focused primarily on public secondary schools, relied heavily on the self-reported perspectives of school administrators, and provided limited attention to the experiences and perceptions of students themselves.

Furthermore, regional studies indicate that cultural diversity, differences in administrative capacity, and variations in resource allocation significantly influence the implementation and effectiveness of drug prevention programs. The application of standardized school health policies may be affected by changing educational contexts, socio-demographic differences, and parental concerns regarding how institutional welfare programs are implemented (Salanguit et al., 2024). These findings emphasize the need for localized evaluation, particularly

within higher education institutions where implementation structures and student populations may differ significantly.

Within the Cordillera Administrative Region, Baguio City presents a distinct setting for examining drug prevention initiatives due to its role as a major educational center in Northern Philippines. The city accommodates a diverse student population composed of individuals from different provinces, cultural backgrounds, and social environments. This unique demographic characteristic creates additional responsibility for private higher education institutions to establish effective programs that promote student welfare, safety, and responsible decision-making.

At the local government level, anti-illegal drug strategies in Baguio City combine executive directives with targeted enforcement operations aimed at addressing drug distribution networks. On April 20, 2026, Baguio City Mayor Benjamin Magalong issued a warning directing drug personalities to leave the municipality or face legal prosecution while instructing the Philippine Drug Enforcement Agency (PDEA) and local police authorities to intensify operations. According to Magalong, although the city’s drug situation had not reached a critical level,

recent indicators showed an increase in drug-related cases, leading to the assessment that no barangay within the city could be considered completely free from illegal drugs (Quitasol, 2026).

This intensified local response is reflected in enforcement outcomes within Baguio City and its surrounding transit areas. On September 12, 2025, a joint operation conducted by the PDEA Cordillera Baguio-Benguet Provincial Office, the Regional Special Enforcement Team (RSET), and the Baguio City Police Office resulted in the arrest of a 49-year-old high-value drug personality at Purok Magsaysay, Loakan Proper, Baguio City. The operation, conducted through a judicial search warrant, resulted in the confiscation of approximately 15 grams of suspected shabu valued at ₱102,000.00, along with three plastic sachets and drug paraphernalia, leading to charges under Sections 11 and 12, Article II of Republic Act No. 9165 (PIA CAR, 2025).

Local reports also demonstrate that young individuals remain vulnerable to drug-related involvement. In Baguio City, authorities previously arrested three individuals, including a 17-year-old student, during an anti-drug operation involving illegal substances and related paraphernalia (Agoot, 2021). This incident highlights the

continued relevance of strengthening preventive education programs within schools and higher education institutions to address youth vulnerability.

Beyond urban distribution networks, local enforcement operations have also identified the movement of illegal substances through regional transportation routes. During a drug interdiction operation at a checkpoint in Ampawilen, Poblacion, Sadanga, Mountain Province, regional police units and PDEA Cordillera operatives intercepted two male students aged 18 and 21 traveling by motorcycle from Buscalan, Kalinga. The inspection revealed approximately two kilograms of dried marijuana stalks wrapped in transparent masking tape, alongside other non-drug items (Quitasol, 2026). The involvement of young students in these situations reinforces the importance of preventive programs that address awareness, decision-making, and resistance to drug-related pressures.

As a recognized educational hub in Northern Philippines, Baguio City’s diverse student population creates a complex environment where private higher education institutions play an essential role in promoting student protection and preventive education. Recognized by UNESCO as a Creative City of Crafts and Folk Art, the city integrates cultural diversity, higher education, and

community development, creating an environment where institutions must respond to varied student experiences and social influences.

Unlike public educational institutions that primarily operate through standardized government funding and policies, private higher education institutions function under different administrative structures, institutional priorities, and resource allocation systems. These differences may influence how the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) is implemented, monitored, and sustained across institutions. Therefore, evaluating NDEP within private higher education institutions requires consideration of institutional conditions and student perspectives to determine whether prevention strategies are effectively reaching their intended beneficiaries.

Evaluating the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) requires consideration of both students' awareness of the program and their perceptions of its effectiveness, while recognizing institutional implementation as an important contextual aspect of the program. Republic Act No. 9165 serves as the primary legal foundation governing drug prevention and education frameworks within Philippine educational institutions (Respicio, 2024). Under Section 43 of this act, drug abuse prevention and control education

must be integrated into the curricula of all public and private schools.

Student awareness is an important indicator in determining how well students understand and recognize the purpose of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP). Awareness of the program may be reflected through students' *knowledge of program objectives*, *drug prevention concepts*, and *available support services*.

Knowledge of program objectives refers to students' understanding of the goals and purpose of the NDEP, including its role in preventing drug abuse, promoting informed decision-making, and developing responsible attitudes toward substance use. The Department of Education (2018) emphasizes that NDEP aims to provide learners with awareness of the harmful effects of dangerous drugs, preventive measures, legal implications, and intervention mechanisms to support a drug-free lifestyle.

Also, drug prevention concepts refer to students' understanding of the principles, strategies, and practices that help prevent drug use and related risks. These include awareness of the effects of dangerous drugs, risk and protective factors, healthy lifestyle choices, and preventive approaches promoted through school-based programs. Effective drug prevention education focuses on

providing accurate information and developing skills that enable students to make informed decisions and avoid substance-related harm (World Health Organization, 2018).

Moreover, available support services refer to students' awareness of the assistance and interventions provided for individuals affected by drug-related concerns. These include counseling, referral systems, treatment, rehabilitation, and other support mechanisms that help address drug-related risks and promote early intervention (Department of Education, 2018).

In this study, knowledge of program objectives, drug prevention concepts, and available support services serve as indicators in assessing the level of student awareness of the National Drug Education Program among respondents.

While student awareness reflects how well learners understand the objectives, concepts, and support mechanisms of the NDEP, perceived effectiveness reflects how students assess the extent to which the program addresses their needs and contributes to positive outcomes. Institutional implementation provides an important contextual dimension because the delivery of drug prevention activities, services, and support mechanisms may shape students' experiences of the program. In the present study, institutional implementation is considered contextual

information rather than a separate research variable to be statistically tested.

The implementation of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) in educational institutions involves various strategies that integrate drug prevention into academic and institutional practices. One important component is *curriculum integration*, which refers to the incorporation of drug prevention concepts into classroom instruction and academic activities. Through curriculum integration, students are provided with knowledge about the harmful effects of dangerous drugs, preventive measures, legal implications, intervention procedures, and available support services. This approach allows drug prevention education to become part of the learners' overall educational experience rather than a separate topic (Department of Education, 2018).

Another component of NDEP implementation is *co-curricular activities*, which refer to organized learning experiences conducted outside regular classroom instruction that support and enhance the formal curriculum. These activities provide opportunities for students to apply knowledge, develop skills, and participate in initiatives that promote drug prevention. Examples include drug awareness seminars, advocacy campaigns, student

organizations, and other school-based programs that encourage responsible decision-making and a drug-free lifestyle (Kumar, 2026).

Lastly, *research, monitoring, and evaluation* serve as essential components in determining the effectiveness and sustainability of NDEP implementation. These processes involve assessing program activities, monitoring progress, gathering feedback, and identifying areas for improvement to ensure that drug prevention initiatives remain responsive to students' needs (Luli, 2024; Villamer, 2020).

Curriculum integration, co-curricular activities, and research, monitoring, and evaluation are recognized in this study as contextual aspects of NDEP implementation. These aspects provide background for understanding the institutional environment in which students encounter drug prevention education and support services. Rather than being treated as a separate variable for correlation analysis, institutional implementation is considered contextual information that may assist in interpreting the findings on student awareness and perceived effectiveness.

Beyond assessing NDEP implementation and student awareness, the effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) may also be determined through students' perceptions of the program's influence on their behaviors,

confidence, and school environment. As a preventive education initiative, NDEP aims to develop responsible decision-making, strengthen students' ability to avoid drug-related risks, and promote a safe and supportive learning environment (Department of Education, 2018).

One indicator of perceived effectiveness is *behavioral guidance*, which refers to the extent to which NDEP helps students develop responsible attitudes, make informed decisions, resist negative influences, and practice behaviors consistent with a drug-free lifestyle. Through drug prevention education and school-based activities, NDEP provides students with knowledge and guidance that support positive behavioral choices.

Another indicator is *self-efficacy*, which refers to students' confidence in their ability to avoid illegal drug use, resist peer pressure, and apply preventive knowledge in real-life situations. NDEP supports the development of self-efficacy by promoting life skills, decision-making abilities, and protective behaviors among learners.

Lastly, *campus safety* refers to students' perception of how NDEP contributes to creating a secure, supportive, and drug-free educational environment. Through prevention programs, awareness activities, and institutional support mechanisms, NDEP helps strengthen a campus culture that

discourages drug-related behaviors and promotes student well-being.

In this study, behavioral guidance, self-efficacy, and campus safety serve as indicators in assessing the perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program among respondents.

The reviewed literature demonstrates that drug abuse remains a complex global concern that requires comprehensive, evidence-based, and sustainable prevention strategies. International frameworks emphasize that educational institutions play a significant role in reducing drug-related risks by developing students' knowledge, decision-making abilities, life skills, and self-efficacy. However, global evidence indicates that traditional and isolated school-based interventions often produce limited outcomes, particularly in reducing alcohol, cannabis, and illicit drug use. These findings highlight the need for prevention programs that move beyond information dissemination and incorporate institutional support, community involvement, continuous evaluation, and student-centered approaches.

International prevention models such as the Unplugged curriculum, Life Skills Training (LST), and the Icelandic Prevention Model demonstrate that effective drug prevention

requires a combination of educational strategies, psychosocial development, and environmental support. These approaches emphasize that prevention becomes more meaningful when students are equipped with practical skills, supported by their institutions, and provided with environments that encourage healthy decision-making. Despite these developments, literature also reveals that program effectiveness remains dependent on how prevention frameworks are adapted and implemented within specific institutional and cultural contexts.

In the Philippine setting, drug prevention efforts are anchored on Republic Act No. 9165, which mandates the integration of drug abuse prevention and control education in all levels of education. Through the National Drug Education Program (NDEP), educational institutions are expected to establish preventive mechanisms through curriculum integration, co-curricular activities, and monitoring and evaluation systems. However, national studies and reports indicate that the presence of policies and programs does not automatically ensure effectiveness. Implementation challenges, resource limitations, and differences in institutional capacity influence how these initiatives are experienced by students.

The Philippine context further demonstrates the continuing importance of strengthening school- and community-based prevention efforts. Although national programs such as NDEP and recent initiatives such as “The Northern Shield 2026” emphasize awareness, early intervention, and student support, regional and local drug-related concerns remain evident. The Cordillera Administrative Region, including Baguio City, continues to experience challenges related to illegal drug production, distribution, and youth vulnerability. These conditions highlight the importance of evaluating prevention programs within specific educational environments rather than relying solely on national-level policies and assumptions.

Existing literature also suggests that higher education institutions require particular attention because universities operate within different administrative and organizational structures compared to basic education institutions. Private higher education institutions may differ in terms of resources, program management, institutional priorities, and implementation strategies. Therefore, the effectiveness of NDEP within private universities cannot be fully understood without examining both institutional implementation and student perspectives.

The literature further establishes the importance of examining students' awareness of drug prevention programs alongside their perceptions of program effectiveness. Students who understand the objectives, concepts, and available support mechanisms of a prevention program may be better positioned to recognize its relevance to their needs. Examining the association between student awareness and perceived effectiveness can therefore provide a student-centered perspective on how the NDEP is understood and experienced by its intended beneficiaries.

Thus, the reviewed literature supports the need for a student-centered evaluation of the National Drug Education Program within private higher education institutions. Considering institutional implementation as contextual information, together with examining students' awareness and perceived effectiveness, may provide a clearer understanding of how the NDEP is experienced within private higher education institutions. This approach focuses on students' reported awareness and perceptions while using relevant institutional context to support the interpretation of the findings.

Despite the existence of comprehensive drug prevention policies and institutional initiatives, significant gaps remain in understanding the effectiveness of the National

Drug Education Program (NDEP), particularly within private higher education institutions. Existing Philippine studies have largely focused on elementary and secondary education settings, leaving limited evidence regarding how drug prevention programs are implemented and sustained within colleges and universities.

Furthermore, previous research has frequently relied on the perspectives of school administrators, teachers, or program implementers, while giving limited attention to the experiences and perceptions of students who are the primary beneficiaries of these programs. Since students directly experience institutional initiatives such as classroom instruction, awareness campaigns, and support services, their level of awareness and perception of program effectiveness provide essential information in evaluating NDEP implementation.

Although policies such as Republic Act No. 9165 and the National Drug Education Program provide a national framework for drug prevention, limited research has examined the association between students' awareness of NDEP and their perceived effectiveness of the program, particularly within private higher education institutions. There remains a need for student-centered evidence describing how well students understand the program and how

they perceive its effectiveness within their educational environment. It remains unclear whether stronger implementation of curriculum-based activities, co-curricular programs, and monitoring mechanisms results in greater student understanding and appreciation of drug prevention initiatives.

This research gap is further evident among private higher education institutions, where differences in administrative structures, institutional priorities, and resource allocation may influence how NDEP is carried out. Unlike public institutions that operate under more standardized government systems, private universities have varying approaches to program development, implementation, and sustainability. These differences create a need for context-specific evaluation.

Moreover, within the Cordillera Administrative Region and Baguio City, where drug-related concerns and student vulnerability remain present, limited research has examined how higher education institutions respond through preventive education programs. Existing regional evidence emphasizes the need for localized assessment, yet there remains insufficient understanding of how NDEP functions within private universities and how students perceive its effectiveness.

Therefore, this study addresses the identified gap by examining student awareness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) and perceived effectiveness of the program among students in selected private higher education institutions in Baguio City. Specifically, the study describes students' level of awareness and their perceived effectiveness of NDEP and determines whether a significant association exists between these two variables. Institutional implementation is considered as contextual information in interpreting the findings rather than as a separate variable subjected to correlational analysis. Through a descriptive-correlational research design, the study provides a student-centered perspective on the relationship between students' awareness and their perceptions of NDEP effectiveness.

This study aims to examine student awareness and perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) in selected private higher education institutions in Baguio City. Specifically, it seeks to determine students' level of awareness of the NDEP, assess their perceived effectiveness of the program, and determine whether a significant association exists between student awareness and perceived effectiveness. Relevant information regarding institutional implementation will be considered

as contextual information in interpreting the findings. The study further aims to provide recommendations that may contribute to the strengthening of NDEP-related drug prevention and education initiatives in private higher education institutions.

Furthermore, this study contributes to a deeper understanding of how students perceive and engage with the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) in private higher education institutions. The findings may offer valuable insights into the factors influencing student awareness and perceptions of program effectiveness, while relevant aspects of institutional implementation will provide context for interpreting the results. Specifically, the findings of this study will be beneficial to the following groups:

Dangerous Drugs Board (DDB) and Other Government Agencies. The results of this study may provide additional evidence regarding the implementation and perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program in private higher education institutions. These findings may support the continuous improvement of drug prevention strategies, educational campaigns, and collaborative initiatives among educational institutions and government agencies.

Commission on Higher Education (CHED). The findings may provide valuable information that can assist CHED in assessing the implementation of drug education initiatives in private higher education institutions. This offers a localized look at how national mandates are actually being rolled out in private higher education settings to see if current frameworks are scalable or if training models need adjustment.

University Administrators and Policy Makers. The results will give private university leaders clear, student-focused data on how well their current drug prevention programs are working. Instead of just checking boxes for government compliance, they can use this feedback to adjust their budgets, improve administrative structures, and design better anti-drug policies tailored to their specific student populations.

Educators, Guidance Counselors, and Student Affairs Officers. Because programs like "The Northern Shield 2026" rely on school staff to spot early drug risks, this study will help these professionals understand where student awareness is lacking. It will show them if current seminars, co-curricular activities, and support systems are truly changing student attitudes and life skills, allowing them to provide better counseling and early intervention.

The Student Body. Students are the primary beneficiaries of this research. By evaluating their awareness and feedback, this study helps ensure that campus anti-drug initiatives move away from purely punitive punishments and move toward building real life skills, self-efficacy, and a genuinely safe, drug-free university environment.

Future Researchers. This study addresses a major gap in local literature by focusing on tertiary education and private universities rather than public basic education. Future researchers can use these descriptive-correlational findings as a baseline or reference point for deeper studies on school-based drug prevention in other regions of the Philippines.

Theoretical and Conceptual Framework

This section presents the theoretical and conceptual framework of the study. It discusses the theories that provide the foundation for examining the relationship between student awareness and perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP), and illustrates how these two variables are correlated in the study. Relevant aspects of institutional implementation are also discussed as supporting information to complement the triangulation and interpretation of the study findings.

Theoretical Framework

Drug prevention in higher education is not merely a matter of regulatory compliance; it is a dynamic process where institutional delivery shapes student cognition, and student cognition alters behavior. This study synthesizes Bandura's Social Cognitive Theory, the Health Belief Model, and Institutional Theory to map out how organizational structures translate into meaningful student-level outcomes.

Social Cognitive Theory. Shaping Self-Efficacy and Action. The primary psychological foundation of this study is Albert Bandura's Social Cognitive Theory (SCT), which explains that human behavior is shaped and maintained through the continuous interaction of environmental influences, cognitive processes, and behavioral patterns.

In this study, program implementation functions as the environmental factor. When private universities implement curriculum integration, defined as the structured inclusion of drug abuse prevention topics within general education or professional subjects, they modify the students' academic environment. In addition, co-curricular activities such as student-led campaigns, seminars, and peer-led awareness initiatives provide social modeling contexts where students

can observe and learn positive, drug-free behaviors from their peers.

SCT emphasizes that environmental interventions are insufficient unless they develop an individual's self-efficacy, which in this study refers to a student's self-rated confidence in resisting peer pressure and avoiding substance use in high-risk social situations.

Through structured intervention and support mechanisms, defined as the availability and accessibility of university guidance counseling, student wellness programs, and non-stigmatizing referral systems, higher education institutions provide essential behavioral reinforcement.

Consequently, the perceived effectiveness of the NDEP is demonstrated when students internalize these institutional efforts, resulting in enhanced life skills and critical decision-making capacities to resist drug use.

The Health Belief Model. Cognitive Pathways of Student Awareness. While SCT explains the behavioral mechanisms, the Health Belief Model (HBM) clarifies the cognitive processes underlying preventive action by linking student awareness to perceived effectiveness. The HBM posits that an individual's decision to engage in preventive behavior

is shaped by their perception of a health threat and the perceived benefits of taking action.

In this study, student awareness is operationally defined as the level of knowledge students have regarding NDEP objectives, the physiological and legal risks of illicit substances, and the location and functions of campus support services. Based on the HBM, students are more likely to value drug prevention when institutional initiatives increase their perceived severity of drug abuse, including its legal, social, and health consequences, as well as their perceived susceptibility to these risks.

Moreover, the educational campaigns implemented by private universities function as cues to action, which are strategies that prompt students to engage with campus resources.

In this study, a safe environment refers to the collective perception among students that the university campus is a secure and protective space free from the presence, distribution, and influence of illegal substances. Within the Health Belief Model, when students have high awareness, they are more likely to perceive the benefits of remaining drug-free as greater than the

perceived barriers, thereby reinforcing the overall effectiveness and value of the institutionalized NDEP.

The functional mechanism of "how" these elements interact follows a strategic, step-by-step pathway within the university environment, driven by the direct relationship between institutional input and student cognitive response.

Rather than being viewed as causal factors, student awareness and perceived effectiveness are examined as related variables in understanding students' experiences of the National Drug Education Program, with program implementation providing the institutional context for the program.

First, when a private university rigorously implements the NDEP by embedding drug education into courses and maintaining visible co-curricular activities, it fundamentally alters the socio-cultural campus environment.

This structural reinforcement builds their self-efficacy and refusal skills, leading them to evaluate the NDEP as a genuinely effective, protective shield rather than a hollow administrative mandate.

Institutional Theory. Navigating the Private Higher Education Landscape. To account for macro-level differences that influence program delivery, this study adopts

Institutional Theory, originally advanced by John Meyer and Brian Rowan. This theory explains how organizational structures are shaped by institutional environments, regulatory requirements, and cultural expectations.

In this study, the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) is treated as an institutional mandate derived from Section 43, Article IV of Republic Act No. 9165. While public universities receive direct government funding to implement such mandates, private higher education institutions (HEIs), defined as non-state-funded, privately owned, and independently managed universities in Baguio City, must comply while balancing distinct administrative structures, institutional priorities, and resource allocation systems.

Institutional Theory suggests that private organizations often experience "decoupling," where formal policies are adopted to achieve legitimacy, but actual implementation differs due to limited resources or competing institutional priorities.

In the context of Baguio City, a UNESCO Creative City known for its cultural diversity and large transient student population, private HEIs face distinct social and institutional pressures. As a result, examining program

implementation through an institutional perspective helps explain variations across private universities.

It highlights that an institution's administrative capacity and resource allocation directly influence the quality, frequency, and sustainability of drug prevention programs, which in turn affect student awareness and the overall effectiveness of the program.

Conceptual Framework

The conceptual framework of this study presents the relationship between student awareness and perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) within the institutional context of NDEP implementation in selected private higher education institutions in Baguio City. It provides a guide for examining the identified variables in relation to students' experiences and perceptions of the program.

Variable 1 of the study is student awareness of the NDEP, which refers to the level of students' knowledge and understanding regarding illegal drugs, their effects, relevant drug-related laws and policies, as well as the programs, activities, and services provided under the NDEP.

Meanwhile, variable 2 is the perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program, which refers to students' assessment of how effectively the program

addresses its intended objectives, including increasing knowledge about drug abuse, promoting positive attitudes and decision-making, encouraging a drug-free lifestyle, and supporting drug prevention efforts within the institution. The study examines whether a significant relationship exists between student awareness and perceived effectiveness of the NDEP.

Perceived institutional implementation provides the institutional context of the study and refers to the extent to which NDEP-related initiatives are integrated and carried out within the institution. This includes curriculum integration, co-curricular activities, and research, monitoring, and evaluation. It is presented as contextual information regarding how the NDEP is implemented in the participating institutions rather than as an independent or causal variable.

Selected demographic characteristics of the respondents, such as age, sex, year level, academic program, institution, and socioeconomic background, are included to describe the respondents and provide contextual information for interpreting the findings. These characteristics are not treated as independent, dependent, or control variables unless specifically included in the statistical analysis of the study.

Overall, the framework proposes that student awareness and perceived effectiveness are related dimensions in understanding students' experiences of the NDEP, with perceived institutional implementation providing the institutional context in which the program is carried out. The framework therefore focuses on the examination of the relationship between Variable 1 and Variable 2 without implying a direct causal effect of one variable on the other.

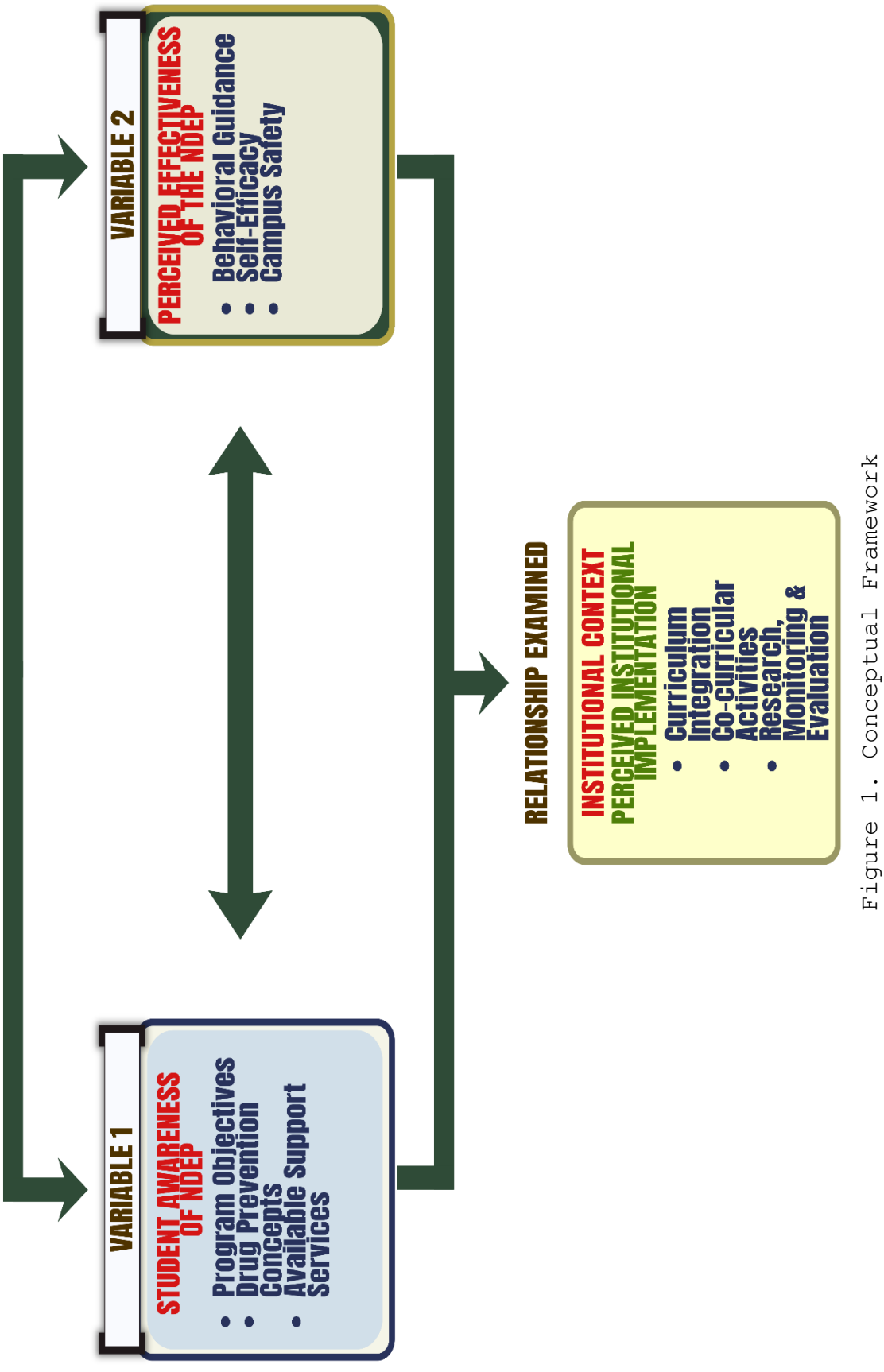


Figure 1. Conceptual Framework

Operational Definition of Terms

National Drug Education Program (NDEP). This refers to the institutionalized drug prevention and education program mandated under Section 43, Article IV of Republic Act No. 9165 and implemented in private Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) in Baguio City. In this study, NDEP refers to the institutional initiatives, activities, and support mechanisms intended to increase student awareness, promote preventive behaviors, and support a drug-free educational environment.

Student Awareness. This refers to Variable 1 of the study, representing the level of students' knowledge and understanding of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP). In this study, student awareness is measured through knowledge of program objectives, understanding of drug prevention concepts, and awareness of available support services provided by the institution.

Knowledge of Program Objectives. This refers to students' understanding of the purpose, goals, and intended outcomes of the National Drug Education Program. In this study, it refers to students' awareness of NDEP's role in preventing drug abuse, promoting responsible decision-making, and developing a drug-free lifestyle.

Drug Prevention Concepts. This refers to students' understanding of information, principles, and strategies related to preventing drug use and reducing drug-related risks. In this study, it includes students' knowledge of the harmful effects of dangerous drugs, legal consequences, risk factors, protective factors, and preventive practices.

Available Support Services. This refers to students' awareness of institutional assistance and intervention services related to drug prevention and student welfare. In this study, it includes guidance counseling, student wellness programs, referral systems, and other support mechanisms available within the institution.

Program Implementation. This refers to the strategies, activities, and support systems undertaken by private Higher Education Institutions in carrying out the National Drug Education Program (NDEP). In this study, program implementation is considered as institutional context describing how NDEP-related initiatives are carried out within the participating institutions. Specifically, it encompasses curriculum integration, co-curricular activities, and research, monitoring, and evaluation.

Curriculum Integration. This refers to the systematic incorporation of drug prevention topics, concepts, and discussions into classroom instruction within general

education or professional courses. In this study, it refers to how drug prevention education is embedded into the academic learning experiences of students.

Co-curricular Activities. This refers to organized student-centered activities conducted outside regular classroom instruction that support the objectives of NDEP. In this study, these include drug awareness seminars, advocacy campaigns, student organizations, peer-led activities, training programs, and other institutional initiatives that promote drug prevention.

Research, Monitoring, and Evaluation. This refers to the processes used by private Higher Education Institutions to assess, monitor, and improve the implementation of NDEP. In this study, it includes program assessment, collection of feedback, monitoring of activities, evaluation of outcomes, and identification of areas for improvement.

Intervention and Support Mechanisms. This refers to institutional services and strategies designed to provide assistance to students experiencing drug-related risks or concerns. In this study, it includes guidance counseling, student wellness programs, referral systems, and non-stigmatizing interventions that support early identification and assistance.

Perceived Effectiveness. Perceived effectiveness of NDEP refers to Variable 2 of the study, representing students' assessment of the extent to which the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) addresses its intended preventive objectives. In this study, perceived effectiveness is measured through behavioral guidance, self-efficacy, and campus safety.

Behavioral Guidance. This refers to the extent to which students perceive that NDEP supports responsible decision-making. In this study, it refers to students' perception that NDEP helps them make responsible decisions, avoid drug-related risks, and practice behaviors consistent with a drug-free lifestyle.

Self-Efficacy. This refers to students' confidence in their ability to resist peer pressure, avoid illegal drug use, and apply preventive knowledge when faced with situations involving drug-related risks. In this study, it reflects students' perceived capability to maintain drug-free behaviors.

Campus Safety. This refers to students' perception that their educational environment is secure, supportive, and protective against drug-related risks. In this study, it refers to the extent to which NDEP contributes to creating a safe and drug-free campus environment.

Student Support Services. This refers to institutional programs and resources that promote student welfare, prevention, and early intervention related to drug concerns. In this study, these include counseling services, wellness programs, referral mechanisms, and other forms of assistance provided by the institution.

Higher Education Institutions (HEIs). This refers to institutions that provide tertiary education programs. In this study, HEIs specifically refer to private universities in Baguio City that implement academic programs, student services, and drug prevention initiatives.

Private Higher Education Institutions. This refers to non-government higher education institutions in Baguio City that operate under private administration and provide tertiary education programs and student services.

Perceived Institutional Implementation. This refers to students' perceptions regarding the extent to which the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) is implemented within their institution. In this study, it encompasses curriculum integration, co-curricular activities, and research, monitoring, and evaluation.

Respondent Demographic Characteristics. This refers to the selected characteristics of the respondents considered for describing the study population and providing

contextual information for interpreting the findings. In this study, these characteristics include age, sex, year level, academic program, institution, and socioeconomic background.

Age. This refers to the chronological age of the student respondents at the time of data collection.

Sex. This refers to the biological sex classification of respondents as indicated in the research instrument.

Year Level. This refers to the academic classification of student respondents based on their current year of study in their respective programs.

Academic Program. This refers to the degree program or field of study in which respondents are currently enrolled.

The Input-Process-Output-Outcome (IPOO) Research Paradigm is employed to present the systematic flow of the study. It illustrates how the information and variables gathered from the respondents are processed through appropriate research procedures to generate findings and recommendations that may contribute to the continuous improvement and sustainability of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) in selected private higher education institutions (HEIs) in Baguio City.

As presented in Figure 1, the Input component consists of the information and variables gathered from the

respondents. This includes the respondents' demographic and academic characteristics, specifically age, sex, year level, and institutional affiliation, which provide contextual information for describing the respondents and interpreting the findings. The input also includes the two variables examined in the study: Variable 1, Student Awareness, and Variable 2, Perceived Effectiveness of the NDEP. Perceived institutional implementation is also considered as institutional context describing how NDEP-related initiatives are carried out within the participating institutions.

The Process component describes the systematic procedures undertaken to transform the gathered information into meaningful findings. This includes the development, validation, reliability testing, and administration of the research instrument to ensure that the measures appropriately capture the constructs under investigation. It also encompasses data collection, organization, processing, and management procedures to maintain the accuracy and integrity of the gathered data.

Furthermore, descriptive statistical treatments such as frequency, percentage, mean, and standard deviation are utilized to describe the respondents and determine the levels of student awareness and perceived effectiveness of

the National Drug Education Program (NDEP). Spearman rank correlation (Spearman's rho) is then employed to determine the significant relationship between student awareness and perceived effectiveness of NDEP. The findings are subsequently analyzed and interpreted to derive conclusions based on the results of the study.

The Output component presents the findings and insights generated from the analysis of the collected data. These include the assessment of students' level of awareness and perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) in selected private higher education institutions in Baguio City. Perceived institutional implementation is considered as contextual information that may help provide a more comprehensive interpretation of the findings.

Moreover, a strategic recommendations matrix will be developed based on the strengths and gaps identified from the findings. The matrix will present possible interventions and improvement strategies relevant to the implementation and effectiveness of NDEP in the participating institutions.

The Outcome component represents the potential contribution of the study to the continuous improvement of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP). The findings

and recommendations generated from the study may serve as a basis for strengthening drug education initiatives, improving student support mechanisms, and supporting the sustained implementation of NDEP in selected private higher education institutions in Baguio City.

These recommendations aim to enhance drug education initiatives, strengthen student support mechanisms, and support the continuous improvement of NDEP in addressing drug-related concerns among students.

Additionally, the feedback mechanism illustrated in the model emphasizes the potential for continuous improvement of NDEP. The findings and recommendations derived from the study may provide valuable information for institutions in reviewing and enhancing their existing policies, programs, and practices related to drug education and prevention.

Through this feedback process, private higher education institutions may use research findings, emerging student needs, and stakeholder perspectives to inform the refinement of their NDEP strategies, thereby supporting the program’s continued relevance, implementation, and perceived effectiveness.

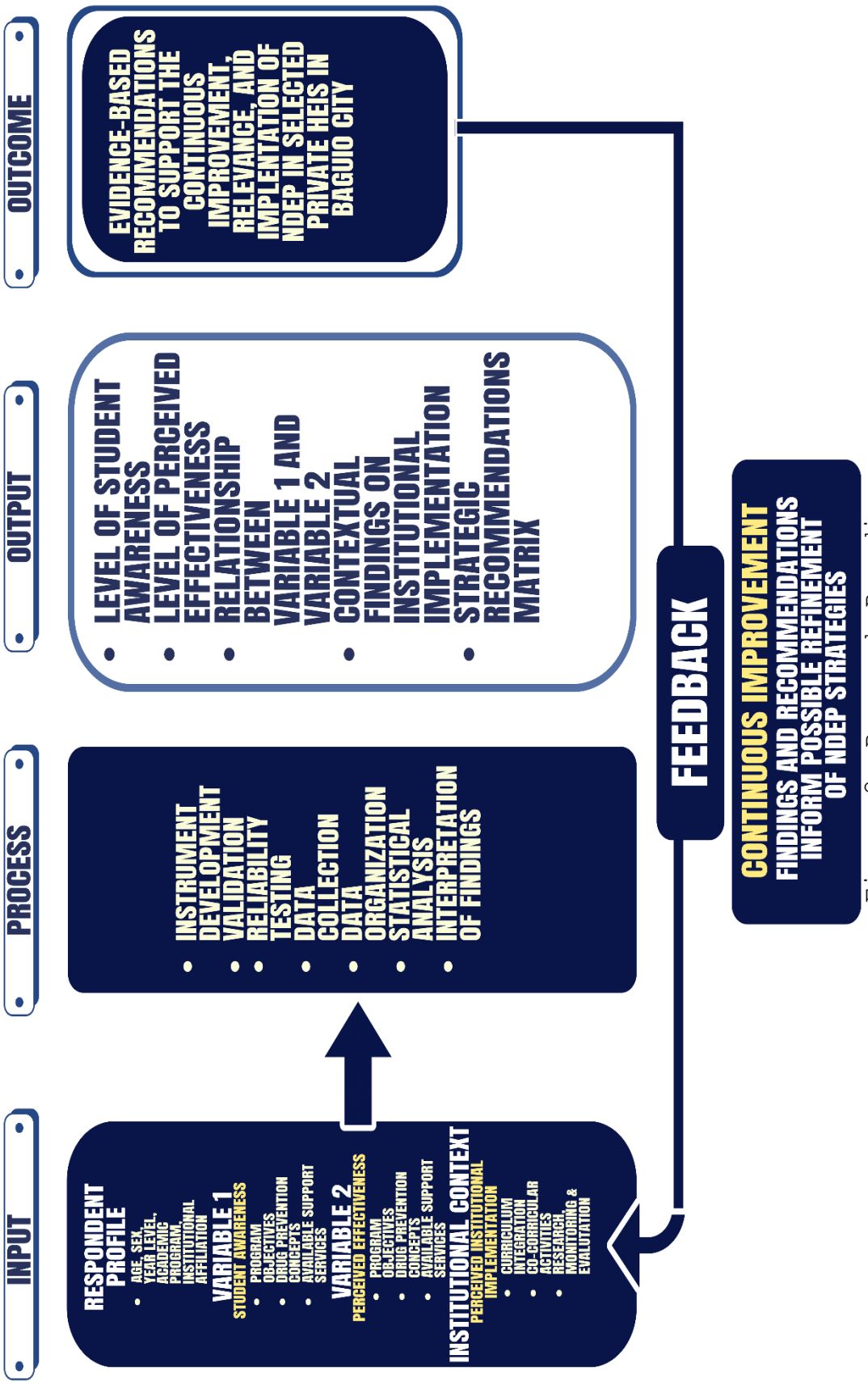


Figure 2. Research Paradigm

Statement of the Problem

This study aims to determine the level of student awareness and perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) in selected private higher education institutions (HEIs) in Baguio City. Furthermore, it seeks to determine the significant relationship between student awareness and perceived effectiveness of the NDEP.

Specifically, it seeks to answer the following research questions:

1. What is the level of student awareness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) in terms of:
    a. knowledge of program objectives;
    b. drug prevention concepts; and
    c. available support services?
2. What is the level of students' perceived effectiveness of the NDEP in terms of:
    a. behavioral guidance
    b. self-efficacy; and
    c. campus safety?
3. Is there a significant relationship between student awareness and the perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP)?

Chapter 2

Design and Methodology

This chapter presents the research design and methodology that will be employed in the study. It explains the research design, the population and locale of the study, the data gathering instrument, the data gathering procedures, the treatment of data, and the ethical considerations that will guide the conduct of the research.

Research Design and Methodology

This study will employ a quantitative descriptive-correlational research design to examine student awareness and perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) in selected private higher education institutions in Baguio City. A quantitative research approach involves the systematic collection, measurement, and analysis of numerical data to describe phenomena, assess variables, examine relationships, and test hypotheses (Hassan, 2026). This approach is appropriate for the present study because it seeks to measure Variable 1, student awareness, and Variable 2, perceived effectiveness of the NDEP, using quantifiable indicators.

Specifically, the descriptive component of the design will be used to determine the levels of student awareness and perceived effectiveness of the NDEP based on the

responses of the selected student participants. Meanwhile, the correlational component will be used to determine whether a significant relationship exists between student awareness and perceived effectiveness of the NDEP without manipulating either variable. A descriptive-correlational design is a non-experimental quantitative research method that describes existing conditions and examines relationships between variables as they naturally occur (Barooah, 2026).

The use of this research design allows the researchers to describe students' awareness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) and their perceived effectiveness of the program in selected private higher education institutions in Baguio City. Furthermore, it enables the researchers to examine whether a significant relationship exists between student awareness and perceived effectiveness of NDEP. The findings may provide a basis for developing evidence-based recommendations to support the continuous improvement of drug education and prevention initiatives in selected private higher education institutions.

Population and Locale of the Study

This study will be conducted in selected private higher education institutions (HEIs) in Baguio City, Philippines. Baguio City was selected as the locale of the

study because it is a major educational center in the Cordillera region, hosting various higher education institutions and a diverse student population. Its private higher education setting provides an appropriate context for examining students' awareness and perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP).

Specifically, the study will be conducted in three (3) selected private higher education institutions in Baguio City: the University of the Cordilleras, University of Baguio, and Baguio Central University. These institutions were selected because they are private higher education institutions that provide tertiary education programs and maintain institutional structures and student services within which NDEP-related drug education and prevention initiatives may be encountered by students. The selection of four institutions is also considered feasible within the available timeframe and resources for data collection, instrument administration, data processing, and interpretation, while allowing the researchers to obtain perspectives from different private higher education settings in Baguio City.

The respondents of the study will comprise undergraduate students from selected academic units, namely

the College/Department of Criminal Justice Education, Nursing, Teacher Education, and Arts and Sciences. These academic units were selected to obtain representation from different fields of study and to provide perspectives from students enrolled in programs with varying academic contexts. Their responses will provide data for determining students' level of awareness and perceived effectiveness of the NDEP.

Furthermore, the study will include only students from the second-year level and above. First-year students will be excluded because they have had a shorter period of exposure to their respective institutions and may therefore have fewer opportunities to encounter institutional programs, activities, policies, and support services related to drug education. In contrast, students from the second to fourth year levels have spent a longer period within their respective institutions, allowing them greater opportunity to encounter NDEP-related initiatives and services. Their inclusion is therefore considered appropriate for examining student awareness and perceived effectiveness of the NDEP based on their experiences within the institution.

To ensure appropriate representation of the target population, this study will use a stratified random

sampling technique. This probability sampling method involves dividing the population into distinct subgroups or strata based on relevant characteristics and randomly selecting respondents from each subgroup. In this study, the strata will be based on institution, academic program, and year level. Proportional allocation will be applied to ensure that each identified subgroup is represented according to its proportion within the target population (Simkus, 2023).

This sampling approach is appropriate because the respondents are drawn from different institutions, academic programs, and year levels, which may provide varied contexts and experiences relevant to their awareness and perceptions of NDEP. Stratified random sampling allows the researchers to obtain representation from the identified subgroups while reducing the possibility that certain groups within the target population will be disproportionately represented in the sample.

The required sample size will be determined using Cochran’s formula, which is commonly used to estimate an appropriate sample size for survey-based studies. The formula considers the desired confidence level, estimated population proportion, and margin of error to determine the initial sample size (Joseph, 2026).

The formula is as follows:

$$n_0 = \frac{Z^2pq}{e^2}$$

Where:

n_0 = required sample size

Z = z-value corresponding to selected confidence level

90% = 1.645; 95% = 1.96; 99% = 2.576

p = estimated proportion of the population

q = 1 - p

e = margin of error

When the population proportion is unknown, p = 0.50 and q = 0.50 may be used to obtain the maximum variability and a conservative sample-size estimate.

After determining the overall sample size, proportional allocation will be applied to distribute the required number of respondents across the identified strata based on institution, academic program, and year level. This procedure will ensure that the composition of the sample reflects the distribution of the target population across the identified subgroups.

Finally, the demographic characteristics of the respondents will include age, sex, year level, academic program, and institution. These characteristics will be

used to describe the respondents and provide contextual information for the interpretation of the study findings.

Data Gathering Tool

The primary data gathering tool to be utilized in this study is a researcher-adapted survey questionnaire. A survey questionnaire is a structured data collection instrument used to obtain information regarding respondents' opinions, perceptions, behaviors, and characteristics through a series of systematically designed questions aligned with the objectives of a study (SurveyMonkey, 2026). As a widely used quantitative research instrument, it enables researchers to collect standardized data from a large number of respondents, facilitating efficient analysis and comparison of research variables.

In this study, the survey questionnaire will be adapted from the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) Monitoring and Evaluation Tool developed by the Department of Education (DepEd), Cordillera Administrative Region, Schools Division of Abra, Bangued, Abra. The researchers will modify the instrument to ensure that its contents are aligned with the objectives of the present study, the two research variables, and the context of selected private higher education institutions in Baguio City. These

modifications will also ensure that the questionnaire is appropriate for the target respondents while maintaining the relevance of the original instrument.

The adapted questionnaire will be used to gather quantitative data on Variable 1, Student Awareness, and Variable 2, Perceived Effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) in selected private higher education institutions in Baguio City. The data obtained from the instrument will serve as the primary basis for determining the levels of the two variables and examining the relationship between them.

The adapted questionnaire will consist of three (3) parts. The first part will gather the demographic and academic profile of the respondents, including age, sex, year level, academic program, and institution. The second part will measure student awareness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) in terms of knowledge of program objectives, drug prevention concepts, and available support services. Lastly, the third part will determine the perceived effectiveness of the NDEP in terms of behavioral guidance, self-efficacy, and campus safety.

The questionnaire will be developed based on the specific indicators identified in the Statement of the Problem to ensure alignment between the research objectives

and the survey instrument. Specifically, Variable 1, Student Awareness, will be measured in terms of knowledge of program objectives, drug prevention concepts, and available support services. Furthermore, Variable 2, Perceived Effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) will be measured in terms of behavioral guidance, self-efficacy, and campus safety. Overall, this alignment ensures that each research variable is directly and appropriately measured by the survey questionnaire.

To measure students' awareness and perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP), this study will use a 4-point Likert scale. A 4-point Likert scale is a commonly used instrument for assessing respondents' opinions, attitudes, and perceptions using four ordered response categories ranging from Strongly Disagree to Strongly Agree. The absence of a neutral midpoint encourages respondents to indicate a clear direction in their responses (ChartEngine Team, 2026). The use of a 4-point Likert scale allows the researchers to quantify students' responses and determine their levels of awareness and perceived effectiveness of the NDEP. The survey questionnaire items will be based on the indicators and dimensions identified in the Department of Education's NDEP framework and guidelines, with necessary modifications

to ensure clarity, relevance, and appropriateness for the target respondents.

The construction of the researcher-adapted questionnaire will be guided by the Department of Education's National Drug Education Program (NDEP) framework, policies, and implementation guidelines. The questionnaire items will be developed based on the indicators identified in the Statement of the Problem, specifically student awareness and perceived effectiveness. The items will be contextualized for the higher education setting while maintaining consistency with the objectives of the study.

Prior to the actual administration, the adapted instrument will undergo content validation to establish its clarity, relevance, and appropriateness. The validation process will involve expert evaluation from individuals with relevant knowledge in drug education, research methodology, and higher education programs. The experts' recommendations will be incorporated to improve the quality and suitability of the questionnaire before its final administration.

Furthermore, the reliability of the adapted instrument will be assessed through a pilot test involving 30 respondents from the participating colleges who possess

characteristics similar to those of the target population but will not participate in the actual study. The sample size for the pilot test is based on methodological recommendations for questionnaire reliability testing using Cronbach's alpha. Bujang et al. (2024) reported that, under specified assumptions for Cronbach's alpha, a minimum of 24 respondents was required, which increased to 30 respondents after allowing for a 20% nonresponse rate. Similarly, Kishore et al. (2021) recommended a pilot-testing sample of approximately 30 to 100 participants for questionnaire development and evaluation. Thus, 30 respondents will be considered sufficient for the pilot reliability testing of the adapted instrument in the present study. The pilot respondents will be selected from the participating colleges and will be excluded from the actual study to ensure that their responses are not included in both the reliability testing and the main data collection.

The internal consistency of the questionnaire will be measured using Cronbach's alpha coefficient for each variable or construct. Cronbach's alpha is a statistical measure used to determine the reliability and internal consistency of survey items by assessing how consistently they measure the same variable. Higher alpha values generally indicate stronger internal consistency among the

items (Frost, 2023). In this study, a Cronbach's alpha coefficient of 0.70 or higher will be considered acceptable, indicating adequate reliability of the instrument for measuring the intended variables.

After the instrument has undergone validation and reliability testing, the final version of the questionnaire will be administered to the selected respondents following the approved data-gathering procedures. For reference, a copy of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) Monitoring and Evaluation Tool developed by the Department of Education (DepEd), Cordillera Administrative Region, Schools Division of Abra, Bangued, Abra, which served as the basis for the adapted survey questionnaire, is attached in Appendix A. Meanwhile, the researcher-modified survey questionnaire, which serves as the primary data-gathering instrument for this study, is attached in Appendix B.

Data Gathering Procedure

The data gathering process will begin with the researchers preparing the researcher-adapted survey questionnaire for content validation and reliability testing to ensure that the instrument is clear, relevant, appropriate, and aligned with the objectives and research variables of the study. After incorporating the necessary revisions based on the recommendations of the validators

and the results of the pilot testing, the final version of the questionnaire will be prepared for administration.

Subsequently, the researchers will seek guidance from the Research Services Office (RSO) of the University of the Cordilleras regarding the applicable standard operating procedures and ethical requirements for the conduct of the study. The research protocol will then be submitted to the University's Ethics Review Committee for ethical evaluation. The researchers will await the issuance of the Notice to Proceed before undertaking any actual data gathering activities.

Upon receiving ethical clearance and the Notice to Proceed, the researchers will secure the necessary approval from the research adviser, school authorities, and the concerned offices or authorized representatives of the selected private higher education institutions in Baguio City. Formal request letters will be submitted to obtain permission to conduct the study and administer the survey questionnaire to eligible undergraduate students. Once permission is granted, the researchers will coordinate with the designated representatives of each participating institution regarding the schedule and procedures for administering the questionnaire.

Following the approval of the participating institutions, the respondents will be selected using the established stratified random sampling procedure. Eligible undergraduate students from the identified academic programs and year levels will be included in the sampling process based on the required sample size and proportional allocation across the identified strata.

Before the administration of the survey questionnaire, the researchers will provide each prospective respondent with an informed consent form. The researchers will explain the purpose of the study, the procedures involved, the voluntary nature of participation, the right to withdraw at any time without penalty, and the measures that will be taken to protect the confidentiality and anonymity of the information provided. Only respondents who voluntarily provide informed consent will be included in the study.

Upon obtaining informed consent, the researchers will administer the survey questionnaire to the selected participants. Clear and standardized instructions will be provided before the questionnaire is accomplished to ensure that respondents understand how to answer the items. The researchers will be available to address questions or requests for clarification regarding the instructions or questionnaire items. However, respondents will be allowed

to complete the questionnaire independently to minimize researcher influence and reduce the possibility of response bias.

After the respondents have completed the questionnaire, the accomplished instruments will be collected and checked for completeness. The responses will then be organized, encoded, and tabulated for statistical processing. The resulting dataset will be subjected to the appropriate statistical treatments to determine the respondents' level of student awareness and perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) and to examine the relationship between the two variables. Finally, all collected data will be securely stored and used solely for the purposes of the study. The researchers will protect the confidentiality and anonymity of the respondents by limiting access to the collected information to authorized members of the research team. All data will be handled, processed, stored, retained, and disposed of in accordance with applicable ethical standards, institutional policies, and the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (Republic Act No. 10173).

Treatment of Data

The data gathered from the respondents will be organized, tabulated, and analyzed using appropriate

statistical tools to answer the research questions and test the hypothesis of the study. Descriptive statistics will be used to summarize and describe the characteristics of the collected data, while inferential statistics will be applied to examine the relationship between the two research variables (Sarker, 2026). In this study, descriptive and inferential statistical methods will be employed to describe the demographic characteristics of the respondents, determine the respondents' level of student awareness and perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP), and examine the relationship between these two variables.

To analyze and interpret the data gathered, the following statistical tools will be employed based on the research questions and the nature of the data being measured:

Frequency and Percentage.

Frequency refers to the number of times a response or category occurs, while percentage expresses the frequency as a proportion of the total number of responses. These descriptive statistics are commonly used to summarize and present categorical data, particularly the demographic characteristics of respondents (Korb, 2013).

In this study, frequency and percentage will be used to describe the demographic profile of the respondents in terms of age, sex, year level, academic program, and institution. These statistical tools will also be used to present the distribution of respondents across the identified demographic categories.

Weighted Mean.

The weighted mean is a statistical measure used to determine the average value of responses by considering the assigned weight of each response, thereby providing a representative overall score (Taylor, 2026).

In this study, the weighted mean will be used to determine the respondents' level of student awareness and perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP). Specifically, it will be applied to the responses obtained through the four-point Likert scale to determine the mean score for each indicator and the overall score for each research variable.

The computed weighted mean values will be interpreted using the following scale:

Table 1.

Four-Point Likert Scale Interpretation

Scale	Range	Verbal Description	Interpretation

4	3.26 – 4.00	Strongly Agree	Very High
3	2.51 – 3.25	Agree	High
2	1.76 – 2.50	Disagree	Low
1	1.00 – 1.75	Strongly Disagree	Very Low

This table presents the four-point Likert scale used in the study to measure the respondents' level of agreement with the statements provided in the survey questionnaire. Each response is assigned a numerical value from 1 to 4, where higher scores indicate a higher level of agreement.

The ranges were determined using the class interval formula:

$$\text{Class Interval} = \frac{\text{Highest Scale Value} - \text{Lowest Scale Value}}{\text{Number of Categories}}$$

$$\text{Class Interval} = \frac{4-1}{4} = 0.75$$

The computed class interval of 0.75 was used to establish four equal categories for interpreting the weighted mean scores. This provides a standardized basis for determining the levels of student awareness and perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP).

The descriptive interpretations presented in Table 1 will serve as the basis for interpreting the weighted mean scores obtained from the respondents' responses. The

corresponding verbal descriptions and weighted mean ranges will guide the researchers in determining the level of student awareness and perceived effectiveness based on the respondents' assessments.

Table 2.

Weighted Mean of Student Awareness of NDEP

Scale	Weighted Mean Range	Verbal Description	Interpretation
4	3.26 – 4.00	Strongly Agree	Very High Student Awareness
3	2.51 – 3.25	Agree	High Student Awareness
2	1.76 – 2.50	Disagree	Low Student Awareness
1	1.00 – 1.75	Strongly Disagree	Very Low Student Awareness

This table presents the interpretation of the weighted mean scores used to determine the respondents' level of student awareness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP). Student awareness will be assessed in terms of knowledge of program objectives, drug prevention concepts, and available support services. The corresponding weighted mean ranges and verbal descriptions provide a basis for determining whether the respondents' level of awareness is very high, high, low, or very low.

The weighted mean scores for the identified awareness indicators will be interpreted using the corresponding weighted mean ranges and verbal descriptions to determine the level of student awareness of the NDEP.

Table 3.

Weighted Mean of Perceived Effectiveness of NDEP

Scale	Weighted Mean Range	Verbal Description	Interpretation
4	3.26 – 4.00	Strongly Agree	Very High Perceived Effectiveness
3	2.51 – 3.25	Agree	High Perceived Effectiveness
2	1.76 – 2.50	Disagree	Low Perceived Effectiveness
1	1.00 – 1.75	Strongly Disagree	Very Low Perceived Effectiveness

This table presents the interpretation of the weighted mean scores used to determine the respondents' perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP). Perceived effectiveness will be assessed in terms of behavioral guidance, self-efficacy, and campus safety. The corresponding weighted mean ranges and verbal descriptions will provide a basis for determining the overall level of perceived effectiveness of the NDEP.

The weighted mean scores for the identified indicators will be interpreted using the corresponding weighted mean ranges and verbal descriptions to determine the level of perceived effectiveness of the NDEP as assessed by the respondents.

Table 4.

Research Variables and Indicators

Research Variable	Indicators
Student Awareness	Knowledge of Program Objectives; Drug Prevention Concepts; Available Support Services
Perceived Effectiveness	Behavioral Guidance; Self-Efficacy; Campus Safety

This table presents the two research variables and their corresponding indicators that will be measured in the study. The identified variables were derived from the objectives and research questions of the study and will serve as the basis for developing and organizing the researcher-adapted survey questionnaire.

The variables and indicators presented in Table 4 will guide the analysis of the respondents' level of student awareness and perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP). The responses obtained from these indicators will be analyzed using the appropriate statistical tools to determine the levels of the two

variables and examine the significant relationship between them.

Standard Deviation.

Standard deviation is a statistical measure that indicates the variability or dispersion of data around the mean (Science Insights Team, 2026). In this study, standard deviation will be used to determine the variability of the respondents' ratings regarding their student awareness and perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP).

It will indicate how closely the respondents' ratings are distributed around the computed weighted mean. Lower standard deviation values indicate that the responses are more closely clustered around the mean, whereas higher values indicate greater variability among the respondents' responses.

Spearman's Rank-Order Correlation Coefficient (Spearman's ρ).

Spearman's rank-order correlation is a nonparametric statistical measure used to determine the strength and direction of a monotonic relationship between two variables, particularly when the data are ordinal or do not

meet the assumptions required for parametric correlation tests (Frost, 2024).

In this study, Spearman's Rank-Order Correlation Coefficient (Spearman's ρ) will be used to determine whether a significant relationship exists between student awareness and perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP). This test will be used to examine the relationship between the two research variables based on the responses obtained through the four-point Likert scale.

Specifically, it will be used to test the following hypothesis:

H_0: There is no significant relationship between student awareness and the perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP).

Ethical Considerations

This study will adhere to established ethical principles to protect the rights, privacy, dignity, safety, and welfare of all respondents throughout the research process. Prior to the conduct of the study, the researchers will seek guidance from the Research Services Office (RSO) of the University of the Cordilleras regarding the applicable ethical requirements and procedures. The research protocol will undergo evaluation by the

University's Ethics Review Committee to ensure compliance with institutional ethical standards and the National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants. Data collection will commence only upon the issuance of the Notice to Proceed.

After obtaining ethical clearance and the Notice to Proceed, the researchers will secure permission from the concerned authorities or authorized representatives of the selected private higher education institutions in Baguio City. Before administering the survey questionnaire, the researchers will provide prospective respondents with an informed consent form that clearly explains the purpose and procedures of the study, its significance, potential risks and benefits, the voluntary nature of participation, and the measures adopted to protect their privacy and confidentiality.

Participation in the study will be entirely voluntary. Respondents will be informed that they have the right to refuse participation or withdraw from the study at any time without penalty or negative consequences. They will likewise be informed that they may decline to answer any question they consider uncomfortable. No respondent will be compelled to participate or provide information against their wishes. These practices uphold the ethical principle

of respect for persons, which emphasizes voluntary participation and informed decision-making in research involving human participants (Philippine Health Research Ethics Board, 2022).

The confidentiality and anonymity of the respondents will likewise be protected throughout the study. Personally identifiable information will not be collected unless necessary for the approved research procedures, and responses will be treated with strict confidentiality and used solely for academic and research purposes. The collected data will be securely stored and will be accessible only to authorized members of the research team. Data will be handled, processed, retained, and disposed of in accordance with applicable institutional policies and the provisions of the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (Republic Act No. 10173).

The researchers will also uphold the principles of honesty, integrity, transparency, and objectivity throughout the conduct of the study. Data will be accurately collected, encoded, analyzed, interpreted, and reported without fabrication, falsification, manipulation, or misrepresentation. The researchers will properly acknowledge the sources used in the study and will ensure

that the findings are presented objectively and based on the data obtained from the respondents.

Finally, the study will comply with the National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants and applicable institutional requirements to ensure the protection of the rights, safety, privacy, and welfare of the respondents throughout all stages of the research process (Philippine Health Research Ethics Board, 2022).

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Appendix A

Adapted NDEP Monitoring and Evaluation Tool

	Republic of the Philippines Department of Education Cordillera Administrative Region **SCHOOLS DIVISION OF ABRA** Bangued, Abra		Document Code: SDOABRA-OF-SGOD-SHS-013 Revision: 00 Effectivity date: 01-14-2019
	NATIONAL DRUG EDUCATION PROGRAM MONITORING AND EVALUATION TOOL		Name of Office: **SCHOOL HEALTH SECTION**

School: _____
School Head: _____
NDEP Coordinator: _____
Assistant NDEP Coordinator: _____

School ID No.: _____
Contact Number: _____
Contact Number: _____
Contact Number: _____

INDICATOR (This is the REQUIREMENT of the standard. This is what the School Health will look for. It refers to measurable variables or characteristics used to determine the degree of adherence to a standard.)	EVIDENT (Put a check ✓ if complied)	NOT EVIDENT (Put an X if not complied)	REMARKS
1. Presence of organized National Drug Education Program (NDEP) School Anti-Drug Abuse Council (SADAC) with respective functions and updated minutes of meeting			
2. Presence of organized Barkada Kontra Droga (BKU) with designated NDEP/BKD Coordinator/s			
3. Presence of Annual Action Plan of SADAC and Barkada Kontra Droga including resource/budgetary allocation			
4. Presence of NDEP corners and Information, Education and Communication (IEC) materials located in an appropriate area			
5. PTA and student organizations are involved in drug prevention activities			
6. Presence of the Previous School Year Annual Accomplishment Report (AAR) of 1.) SADAC and 2.) Barkada Kontra Druga			
7. The school integrates drug abuse prevention in the training of Supreme Student Government, Boy Scouts and Girl Scouts and other clubs and organizations.			
8. Conduct of activities on drugs abuse prevention thru: a) fora or discussion on drug abuse prevention b) poster making contests, slogan and theme writing contests e.g. on drug abuse prevention and control			
9. Provision of guidance and counseling services, peer counseling, referral services, assistance to student surrenders if any			
10. Presence of organized and accredited Senior and/or Senior Plus Red Cross Youth Councils with designated RCY Focal Person			
11. Coordination with GO's and NGO's : a. Municipal Anti-Drug Abuse Council (MADAC) b. Barangay Anti-Drug Abuse Council (BADAC) c. Department of Health (DOH) d. Local Government Unit (LGU) e. Philippine National Police (PNP) f. Others (pls. specify)			

Other Observations:

_____
_____
_____.

Monitored by:

_____
Signature Over Printed Name

Date: _____

Noted by:

_____
Signature Over Printed Name of School Head

Date: _____

Appendix B

Researcher-adapted Survey Questionnaire

University of the Cordilleras
College of Criminal Justice Education

Title of the Study: CORRELATION BETWEEN STUDENT AWARENESS AND PERCEIVED EFFECTIVENESS OF THE NDEP IN SELECTED PRIVATE HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS IN BAGUIO CITY

Invitation to Participate

Dear Participant,

You are invited to participate in this research study. This study is being conducted by second-year Bachelor of Science in Criminology students from the University of the Cordilleras in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of Bachelor of Science in Criminology.

Before deciding whether to participate, please read the following information carefully. If you have questions about the study, you may ask the researchers for clarification before signing this form.

Purpose of the Study

The purpose of this study is to assess the level of student awareness and perceived effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) in selected private higher education institutions in Baguio City. The findings of this study may contribute to strengthening drug education initiatives and enhancing institutional strategies for promoting a drug- free learning environment.

Procedures

If you agree to participate, you will be asked to accomplish a survey questionnaire consisting of three (3) parts. Completing the questionnaire will take approximately 10-15 minutes. There are no right orwrong answers. You are requested to answer all items honestly based onyour own knowledge, experiences, and perceptions.

Voluntary Participation

Your participation in this study is entirely voluntary. You have the right to decline participation or withdraw from the study at any time without penalty or loss of benefits. You may also choose not to answer any question that makes you feel uncomfortable.

Risks and Benefits

This study involves no anticipated physical, psychological, legal, or social risks beyond those ordinarily encountered in daily life. While there may be no direct personal benefit to you, your participation may contribute to improving the implementation and effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program in higher education institutions.

Continuation of Appendix B

Researcher-adapted Survey Questionnaire

University of the Cordilleras
College of Criminal Justice Education

Confidentiality and Data Privacy

All information collected during this study will be treated with strict confidentiality. Your name or any personally identifiable information will not be included in the presentation or publication of the findings. The data collected will be used solely for academic and research purposes and will be stored securely by the researchers.

The handling, processing, storage, and disposal of research data shall comply with the provisions of the **Data Privacy Act of 2012 (Republic Act No. 10173)** and the **National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants (PHREB, 2022).**

Contact Information

If you have any questions regarding this study, you may contact:

Jeriza G. Laplana
Group Leader
Contact Number: 0919 398 2420

CONSENT TO PARTICIPATE

I have read and understood the information provided above. The purpose, procedures, potential risks, and benefits of the study have been explained to me. I have been given the opportunity to ask questions, and all my questions have been answered satisfactorily.

I understand that my participation is voluntary and that I may withdraw from the study at any time without penalty. By signing below, I voluntarily agree to participate in this research study.

Participant's Name (Optional): _____

Signature of Participant: _____

Date: _____

Continuation of Appendix B

Researcher-adapted Survey Questionnaire

University of the Cordilleras
College of Criminal Justice Education

RESEARCHER-ADAPTED SURVEY QUESTIONNAIRE

(Adapted from the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) Monitoring and Evaluation Tool of the Department of Education, Cordillera Administrative Region, Schools Division of Abra, Bangued, Abra)

PART I. RESPONDENT'S PROFILE

Direction: Please provide the following information by writing your answer or placing a check mark (✓) in the appropriate box.

Age: _____

Sex:

☐ Male

☐ Female

☐ Prefer not to say

Name of Institution:

☐ University of the Cordilleras

☐ University of Baguio

☐ Baguio Central University

College/Department:

☐ Criminal Justice Education

☐ Nursing

☐ Teacher Education

☐ Arts and Sciences

Please indicate if none of the above apply:

_____

Year Level:

☐ Second Year

☐ Third Year

☐ Fourth Year

☐ Fifth Year (if applicable)

Use the rating scale below to indicate your response to each statement. Place a check mark (✓) in the column that best represents your answer.

Rating	Verbal Description
4	Strongly Agree
3	Agree
2	Disagree
1	Strongly Disagree

PART II. LEVEL OF STUDENT AWARENESS

Direction: Pleaseindicateyour level of awareness regarding the following statements by placing a check mark (✓) under the column that corresponds to youranswer.

A. Knowledge of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) Objectives

No.	Statement	4	3	2	1
1	I understand the objectives of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP).	☐	☐	☐	☐
2	I understand that the NDEP aims to promote a drug-free educational environment.	☐	☐	☐	☐
3	I am aware of NDEP-related activities implemented by my university within the school premises.	☐	☐	☐	☐
4	I understand the importance of the NDEP in preventing drug abuse among students.	☐	☐	☐	☐
5	I am familiar with the goals and objectives of the NDEP implemented by the university.	☐	☐	☐	☐

Continuation of Appendix B

Researcher-adapted Survey Questionnaire

University of the Cordilleras
College of Criminal Justice Education

B. Drug Prevention Concepts

No.	Statement	4 □	3 □	2 □	1 □
6	I understand the harmful physical, psychological, and social effects of illegal drug use.	□	□	□	□
7	I am aware of the legal consequences associated with the use, possession, and distribution of illegal drugs.	□	□	□	□
8	I am informed about the harmful effects of illegal drug use.	□	□	□	□
9	I am aware of the factors, such as peer pressure and curiosity, that may influence individuals to engage in illegal drug use.	□	□	□	□
10	I understand the role of students in the promotion of a drug-free school and community environment.				

C. Available Support Services

No.	Statement	4 □	3 □	2 □	1 □
11	I am aware that guidance and counseling services are available in my university for students with drug-related concerns.	□	□	□	□
12	I know where to seek assistance if I or another student experiences drug-related concerns.				
13	I am aware that the university provides referral services for students who require specialized assistance related to substance abuse.	□	□	□	□
14	I am aware of the university offices or personnel responsible for implementing drug prevention programs and student support services.	□	□	□	□
15	Information about drug prevention programs and available support services is accessible to students through university announcements, orientations, or other communication platforms.	□	□	□	□

PART III. PERCEIVED EFFECTIVENESS OF THE NDEP

Direction: Please indicate the extent to which you agree with each statement regarding the effectiveness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) in youruniversity by placing a check mark (✓) in the appropriate column.

A. Behavioral Guidance

No.	Statement	4 □	3 □	2 □	1 □
16	The National Drug Education Program encourages me to make responsible and informed decisions.	□	□	□	□
17	The program promotes positive values and responsible behavior among students.	□	□	□	□
18	The program strengthens my commitment to maintaining a drug-free lifestyle.	□	□	□	□
19	The program helps me make responsible decisions regarding situations involving illegal drug use.	□	□	□	□
20	The program encourages students to make healthy lifestyle choices and avoid risky behaviors.				

Continuation of Appendix B

Researcher-adapted Survey Questionnaire

University of the Cordilleras
College of Criminal Justice Education

B. Self-Efficacy

No.	Statement	4 □	3 □	2 □	1 □
21	I am confident that I can refuse illegal drugs if they are offered to me.	□	□	□	□
22	I can resist peer pressure related to illegal drug use.	□	□	□	□
23	I am confident in my ability to take appropriate action when faced with drug-related situations.	□	□	□	□
24	I believe I can make responsible decisions even when influenced by others.	□	□	□	□
25	I feel capable of promoting drug prevention and encouraging a drug-free lifestyle among my peers.				

C. Campus Safety

No.	Statement	4	3	2	1
26	The National Drug Education Program contributes to maintaining a safe and drug-free campus environment.	□	□	□	□
27	I feel safer knowing that the university implements drug prevention programs and policies.	□	□	□	□
28	The university effectively promotes a campus environment that discourages illegal drug use.	□	□	□	□
29	The university provides a supportive environment for students seeking help with drug-related concerns.				
30	Overall, the implementation of the National Drug Education Program enhances the safety and well-being of students on campus.	□	□	□	□

- - - - - - - - - - - - - - END OF QUESTIONNAIRE - - - - - - - - - - - - - -

"Research begins with curiosity but succeeds through participation."

Our Sincere Gratitude

The researchers sincerely thank you for your time, cooperation, and participation. Your honest responses are valuable in achieving the objectives of this study and in enhancing the understanding of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) in selected private higher education institutions in Baguio City.

Rest assured that all information you have provided will be treated with the utmost confidentiality and anonymity and will be used solely for academic and research purposes in accordance with **the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (Republic Act No. 10173)** and established ethical research guidelines.

Thank you and may God bless you a thousandfold!

Respondent's Feedback (Optional):

_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

Appendix C

Notice of Tool Adaptation and Modification

July 29, 2026

To: The Concerned Owner of the NDEP Monitoring and Evaluation Tool

Greetings of grit and excellence!

We are second-year students taking the Bachelor of Science in Criminology program at the University of the Cordilleras. We are currently conducting a research study titled: "**The Interplay of Student Awareness, Institutional Implementation, and Perceived Awareness of the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) in Selected Private Higher Education Institutions in Baguio City**."

We are writing to respectfully inform you that we intend to adapt and modify the NDEP Monitoring and Evaluation Tool by Schools Division of Abra posted on Scribd for use as basis of the research instruments in our study. The modifications are intended solely to ensure that the instrument aligns with the objectives, scope, and context of our research while maintaining its original purpose.

This letter is sent in observance of ethical research principles, particularly transparency, respect for intellectual work, and proper acknowledgment of sources. The adapted instrument will be used exclusively for academic and research purposes as part of the requirements for the completion of our undergraduate study. Appropriate acknowledgment of the original source will be included in our research manuscript.

Our research team consists of the following members:

- Laika Meitch T. Biyong
- Rannie N. Busilan
- Arsen Rylie A. De Leon
- Jeriza G. Laplana (Group Leader)
- Noah A. Sernadilla
- Ma. Elaine P. Te-Od
- Alyzsa Fe P. Tila

We sincerely appreciate your time and consideration. Thank you for making this valuable resource available, which has greatly contributed to our academic undertaking. We hope this letter serves as our formal notification regarding the ethical adaptation of the instrument for our study.

Cordially,

Jeriza G. Laplana
Group Leader
Bachelor of Science in Criminology
University of the Cordilleras
Contact Number: 09193982420
Email Address: 6.jeriza@gmail.com

Proof of Email Submission

LAPLANA, JERIZA <6.jeriza@gmail.com>
to abra

2:25 PM (3 minutes ago)

Good day sir/ma'am!

I hope this message finds you well.

On behalf of our research group from the Bachelor of Science in Criminology program at the University of the Cordilleras, I am respectfully sending our letter regarding our intended adaptation and modification of the NDEP Monitoring and Evaluation Tool for our undergraduate research study.

The letter serves as our formal notification in observance of ethical research practices and our commitment to properly acknowledge the original source of the instrument. We have attached the letter for your reference.

Thank you very much for your time and consideration. We sincerely appreciate your contribution and look forward to your kind acknowledgment.

Respectfully,

Jeriza G. Laplana

One attachment • Scanned by Gmail Add to Drive



Notice of Adaptat...

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Curriculum Vitae



LAIKA MEITCH TUCRANG BIYONG
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PERSONAL INFORMATION

Date of Birth	June 02, 2005
Place of Birth	Kabugao, Apayao
Citizenship	Filipino
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EDUCATION

Tertiary	Bachelor of Science in Criminology University of the Cordilleras Baguio City, Philippines 2600 2024-Current
Secondary	Senior High School University of the Cordilleras Baguio City, Philippines 2022-2024
	Junior High School Apayao Community Learning Center Kabugao, Apayao 2018-2022
Elementary	Kabugao Central School Kabugao, Apayao 2012-2018



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PERSONAL INFORMATION

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EDUCATION

Tertiary	Bachelor of Science in Criminology University of the Cordilleras Baguio City, Philippines 2600 2023-Current
Secondary	Senior High School Laurencio Fianza NHS Itogon, Benguet 2019-2021
	Junior High School Laurencio Fianza NHS Itogon, Benguet 2015-2019
Elementary	Tabu Elementary School Itogon, Benguet 2009-2015



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PERSONAL INFORMATION

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EDUCATION

Tertiary	Bachelor of Science in Criminology University of the Cordilleras Baguio City, Philippines 2600 2024-Current
Secondary	Senior High School Cavite Community Academy Naic, Cavite 2022-2024
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EDUCATION

Tertiary	Bachelor of Science in Criminology University of the Cordilleras Baguio City, Philippines 2600 2024-Current
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Elementary	Saint Augustine’s School Tagudin, Ilocos Sur 2009-2018



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Place of Birth	Olongapo City, Zambales
Citizenship	Filipino
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EDUCATION

Tertiary	Bachelor of Science in Criminology University of the Cordilleras Baguio City, Philippines 2600 2024-Current
Secondary	Morong National High School Morong, Bataan 2018-2024
Elementary	Facundo Angeles Memorial Elementary School Morong, Bataan 2012-2018



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PERSONAL INFORMATION

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Place of Birth	Baguio City, Benguet
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Civil Status	Single
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EDUCATION

Tertiary	Bachelor of Science in Criminology University of the Cordilleras Baguio City, Philippines 2600 2024-Current
Secondary	Pines City National High School Palma St, Baguio, Benguet Baguio City, 2600 2018-2022
Elementary	Josefa Cariño Elementary School Yandoc St, Baguio City, Benguet 2012-2018